Teacher and cover plan — Planning the piece: four composition choices

Pathway: TRACK · Week 3 Part 1 · Big question: How do four deliberate choices — focal point, palette, background pattern, and medium — shape an identity piece?

Learning goals and studio kit

• Test two thumbnail compositions comparing central vs off-centre focal placement.

• Select a purposeful three-colour palette (warm/cool contrast or harmonious tones).

• Produce an annotated A4 composition plan ready for next week's final build.

Studio kit: A3 composition planning sheets, colour wheel reference cards, coloured pencils, oil pastels, fineliners, Week 1-2 log sheets

Arrival and starter

Arrival: Look at the two mini thumbnail sketches on screen. Why do artists draw small rough thumbnails before starting on a big expensive board?

Starter question: What happens if your background pattern uses the exact same tone and line thickness as your central motif?

Teacher model (I do)

Step 1: Draw two contrasting thumbnails: I sketch Thumbnail A (centred motif with radiating pattern) and Thumbnail B (off-centre motif with diagonal grid).

Step 2: Swatch a three-colour palette: I test deep indigo, warm ochre amber, and crisp white in my swatch boxes to guarantee dark-to-light contrast.

Step 3: Scale up the winning plan with annotations: I draw my chosen layout in the main frame and add four pointer notes naming focal point, pattern, palette, and medium.

Practice routes (Supported / Independent / Aspire)

Supported: Two thumbnails, three colour swatches, and a labelled composition plan.

Independent: Complete studio blueprint with thumbnails, value swatches, and four rationale notes.

Aspire: Three thumbnails, live media test strip, and fully annotated composition plan.

TA and cover notes

TA focus: Provide laminated colour-wheel cards showing complementary pairs (blue/orange, purple/yellow, red/green) on each table.

Staff prep: Staff preparation only: review a short demonstration on thumbnailing and separating figure from

patterned ground.